

Results Report: Comparing Histories of Antisemitism in Contemporary Europe (CHACE)

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Background and objectives

Against the background of a resurgence of antisemitism in 21st century Europe, the CHACE project aimed to improve understanding of this phenomenon by charting its trajectories and explaining temporal and geographical variation in its prevalence and intensity. The following key questions were formulated at the outset:

- What characterizes the diverging paths of post-Cold War antisemitism in Europe?
- Why has antisemitism come to afflict some countries more than others, as demonstrated by the varying degrees of anti-Jewish attitudes, variation in number and intensity of antisemitic attacks, and differences in the levels of concern expressed by Jews?

Driven by these questions, the project sought to contribute to academic research, promote interdisciplinary approaches and collaboration, engage with policymakers and stakeholders, and communicate findings to the wider public.

Results achieved

A list of [recorded project outputs](#) is publicly available at the CRISTIN database. In the following, key results are summarized.

1. Scientific publications:

By January 2025, three peer-reviewed articles had been published in academic journals, including *Antisemitism Studies*, *Agora*, and *Social Forces*. These contributions included developing a conceptual and empirical framework for multidimensional research on antisemitism, evaluating the contemporary dynamics of the phenomenon, and analyzing individual- and country-level predictors of victimization and fear among European Jews. Two additional articles are currently undergoing peer review. One of these assesses the drivers of 21st century antisemitism by comparing the cases of Germany, Sweden, and Russia over the period 1990–2020 (published as a [working paper](#) on *SocArXiv*), while the other article analyzes the relationship between antizionist beliefs and justification of anti-Jewish aggression using survey data from Norway.

A doctoral dissertation comparing discourses and experiences of antisemitism in the UK and Poland over the period 1990–2020, which according to initial plans should have been finalized in 2024, has been delayed. We anticipate that the dissertation will be completed in 2025.

2. Other publications

The CHACE project has also resulted in multiple publications targeting broader audiences. These include op-eds in [VG](#) and [Klassekampen](#), a book review in [Minerva](#), a [blog post](#) for the C-REX blog *RightNow!*, as well as articles about the [Jewish Pathfinders project](#) and [antisemitism in Scandinavia](#) in the wake of October 7, 2023. The project PI [contributed to a report](#) commissioned by the Norwegian government evaluating the government’s action plans against antisemitism.

3. Data development:

Moving beyond the originally formulated objectives, the project PI developed and published the [Dimensions of Antisemitism \(DIMA\) dataset](#), a new resource compiling data from various sources on attitudes, incidents, and victimization. We plan for DIMA to be regularly updated in the future, facilitating further research.

4. Outreach and dissemination:

Project researchers have engaged in substantial public dissemination efforts, including academic and public presentations, media contributions, and stakeholder engagement with the Jewish community in Norway. To further these efforts, a project website was developed by the PI: [Documenting Contemporary Antisemitism](#). The webpage serves as a platform to disseminate key findings, provide access to project resources such as the DIMA dataset, and present updates on ongoing research activities. By making these materials publicly available, the webpage helps make the project outputs accessible for researchers, policymakers, and the general public.

5. Collaborative efforts:

As a result of project activities, the PI became involved in collaborative efforts to seek EU funding for establishing a European research hub focusing on antisemitism and Jewish life. Furthermore, the project PI is establishing a partnership with the Jewish Community of Oslo in order to facilitate a future research project assessing the impact of the Jewish Pathfinder Project (“jødiske veivisere”).

Key R&D activities and collaborations

The project was led by the PI, with contributions from a PhD candidate. Key activities included developing and applying a new conceptual/empirical framework for antisemitism

research, collecting and analyzing a broad range of data (e.g., news coverage, in-depth interviews with community representatives, and quantitative survey data reflecting Jews' perceptions and experiences of antisemitism), integrating mixed-methods approaches in comparative-longitudinal studies, and conducting multilevel analyses to understand individual- and country-level variation in victimization. Findings were presented and discussed at workshops, conferences, and public events, including the Oslo Workshop on New Directions in Antisemitism Research.

For executing the project, several academic milieus have played important roles by arranging and facilitating workshops and conferences, discussing ongoing research, and providing feedback. Colleagues at numerous institutions have contributed valuably, including the Institute for Social Research, the Center for Research on Extremism at the University of Oslo, the London Center for the Study of Contemporary Antisemitism, the Institute for Jewish Policy Research in London, and the Center for Holocaust and Minority Studies in Oslo.

Project implementation and resource use

The project was implemented largely according to initial plans and within the given resource limits. Notably, a stronger quantitative social science component was introduced due to emerging methodological interests on the part of the project PI. This reorientation was productive, as it resulted in a research article published in an internationally leading social science journal as well as another quantitative study currently under peer review. Delays occurred in the PhD candidate's contributions, affecting certain planned outputs. All in all, resources were utilized efficiently, with significant outputs achieved relative to the project aims.

International activities

The project involved presenting research at international conferences and collaborating with scholars worldwide. These engagements strengthened methodological approaches and increased the project's visibility in the global research community.

Significance and utility of results

In terms of academic research, CHACE outputs have provided new frameworks and data for understanding antisemitism and laid groundwork for future interdisciplinary collaboration. In terms of theoretical impact, research findings have emphasized the central importance of the "Israel factor" in driving, or catalyzing, antisemitic hostility in contemporary Europe. In terms of policy, findings have been utilized to evaluate and recommend new measures for the Norwegian government's action plan against antisemitism. At the societal level, extensive public dissemination efforts have contributed to higher public awareness and better-informed discussions on antisemitism and related issues.

Plans for further dissemination and utilization

The DIMA dataset will be maintained and expanded to support further research. We will maintain ongoing efforts to publish additional articles and synthesize findings for broader audiences. We also plan to maintain collaboration with the Jewish community in Norway and policymakers to ensure practical relevance and application of insights. Collaborative efforts to secure funding for new projects focusing on antisemitism and Jewish life in Europe are ongoing.

Expected post-project outputs

- Two peer-reviewed articles currently under review are expected to be published in 2025.
- A planned research article analyzing conditions that may explain variation in antisemitic hostility across 20 to 30 European countries using Qualitative Comparative Analysis is anticipated for 2026.

In summary, the CHACE project has achieved its key objectives: contributing significantly to academic research, advancing interdisciplinary approaches and collaboration, engaging with stakeholders, and contributing to the public conversation about the problem of antisemitism.